HARBOURLIGHT MEDIA

Scheduling and Audience Rules

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1. Purpose

These rules say how Harbourlight's schedule is read when a campaign's booked spots are checked against a category code: the broadcast day and its clock, where a break sits, what in and adjacent mean, what live sport coverage is, what the forecast under-18 audience index is and who publishes it, and how the daily limit and the separation are counted.

They apply to all four channels and to every code.

2. The broadcast day and the booking week

Harbourlight's broadcast day runs from 06:00 to 05:59 the next morning. Every schedule, every count and every comparison in a clearance is made on the broadcast day.

A booking covers one booking week of seven broadcast days, named Monday to Sunday. Days are named by weekday only, and no clearance depends on a calendar date.

The small hours of Monday morning, before 06:00, belong to Sunday's broadcast day, not to the booking week's Monday, which opens at 06:00.

3. The broadcast clock

Times on the broadcast day are written on the broadcast clock: 06:00 to 23:59 as usual, then 24:00 to 29:59 for the hours after midnight, so the day runs in one direction from start to finish. A programme ends at 30:00 at the latest, when the next broadcast day opens.

A time on the ordinary clock is moved onto the broadcast clock with one rule. A time from 06:00 belongs to the broadcast day of its own weekday and keeps its clock. A time before 06:00 belongs to the previous weekday's broadcast day, 24 hours later on its clock.

So Sunday 05:40 on the ordinary clock is Saturday 29:40, Saturday 23:10 stays as it is, and Monday 01:10 is Sunday 25:10, because the booking week's Monday opens at 06:00.

A programme's end time at or before 06:00 on the ordinary clock is 24 hours later too. A programme from 23:30 to 00:30 runs from 23:30 to 24:30, and one from 05:30 to 06:00 on Sunday runs from Saturday 29:30 to 30:00.

4. How each channel writes the time

Harbourlight Sport's scheduling system, TXLine, writes the broadcast clock on the broadcast day: a spot at ten past one on Sunday morning is written as Saturday 25:10. TXLine never writes a time before 06:00.

The systems of the other three channels - Airtime Planner for Harbourlight One, SlotMaster for Harbourlight Drama and Planit for Harbourlight Life - write the ordinary clock on the calendar day, so the same spot is written as Sunday 01:10.

Each system also writes weekdays and spot lengths in its own way. A spot's length is always one of the standard lengths, and the last three digits of its clock number give the length in seconds. Where the length written and the clock number disagree, the clock number is right, because it identifies the copy.

5. Restricted hours on the broadcast day

A code writes its restricted hours on the ordinary clock. On the broadcast day they are placed with the same rule: hours from 06:00 keep their clock, and hours before 06:00 move 24 hours later. Restricted hours that begin before 06:00 therefore fall in two parts of the broadcast day, one at its start and one at its end.

For example, hours written as 05:00 to 20:00 cover 06:00 to 20:00 and 29:00 to 30:00 of the broadcast day.

A break at the time restricted hours begin is inside them, and a break at the time they end is outside them. A break at 20:00 is clear of hours ending at 20:00, and a break at 05:00 is inside hours beginning at 05:00.

6. Where a break sits

Every spot is booked into a break, named by the time the break starts.

A break strictly inside a programme - after it starts and before it ends - is a centre break, and a spot in it is in that programme.

A break at the moment one programme ends and the next begins is an end break, and a spot in it is adjacent to both programmes, the one before and the one after.

No break is placed at the very start or the very end of the broadcast day, or in a gap in the schedule. A booking into any of them is refused, not moved to the nearest break.

7. Live sport coverage

A programme the schedule marks as live sport is live sport coverage from its start to its end. Each live sport programme is its own coverage, beginning and ending with the programme, even when another live sport programme comes straight before or after it.

A centre break of a live sport programme is within the coverage. An end break is never within live sport coverage, even between two live sport programmes.

Minutes after the coverage starts are counted from the programme's start to the break, and minutes before it ends from the break to the programme's end. A break at 19:25 in coverage from 19:00 to 21:00 begins 25 minutes after the coverage starts and 95 minutes before it ends.

Studio programmes about sport - previews, highlights, results and magazine programmes - are not live sport coverage, even when they are broadcast live.

8. Programmes made for children

A programme is made for children when the schedule marks it so. The mark is set when the programme is commissioned and does not depend on its audience: a programme made for children stays so whatever its forecast index, and a programme with a high index is not made for children unless it is marked.

9. The forecast under-18 audience index

Harbourlight's audience planning team publishes a forecast under-18 audience index for every programme in the booking week before the week begins, and the programme schedule carries it.

The index compares the share of a programme's audience expected to be under 18 with the share of under-18s in the viewing population. An index of 100 means the programme is expected to draw under-18s in the same proportion as the population, 200 twice that proportion and 50 half of it.

An index is a whole number from 1 to 999.

Clearance always uses the published forecast. The audience measured after a programme has aired is never used to clear or withdraw a spot, and a revised forecast applies only once it is published in the schedule.

10. Counting the daily limit

A code's daily limit is counted per campaign, per channel and per broadcast day. The campaign's spots on that channel in that broadcast day are counted in the order they are transmitted, earliest first, and every spot beyond the limit breaks it.

Every booked spot counts, whether or not it breaks another rule. Two spots of one campaign in one break are transmitted in the order of their spot references.

With a limit of four, for example, the fifth spot of the broadcast day and every spot after it break the limit, and a spot at 01:10 on Sunday morning counts towards Saturday's broadcast day.

11. Measuring the separation

A code's separation is measured from the campaign's previous spot on the same channel in the same broadcast day, whatever that spot's own result. A spot that begins less than the separation after the previous spot breaks the rule; a spot exactly the separation after it does not.

Times are measured between the breaks the spots are booked into, so spots at 20:20 and 20:35 are 15 minutes apart, and two spots of one campaign in one break are zero minutes apart.

The first spot of a broadcast day on a channel has no previous spot, and a spot is never measured against one on another channel or in another broadcast day.

12. How the results are recorded

Every spot is tested against every rule of its category's code. A spot that breaks no rule is compliant. A spot that breaks any rule is recorded against every rule it breaks, in this order: restricted hours (WINDOW), the under-18 audience (INDEX), programmes made for children (CHILDREN), the daily limit (FREQUENCY) and the separation (SEPARATION).

A spot's result never depends on whether another spot complies. The daily limit and the separation count and measure every booked spot, whatever its own result.